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Statement

Information regarding European Commission's restriction of Synthetic Polymer Microparticles (SPM)

Laricyl® BC10206

® = registered trademark of BASF in many countries ™ = Trademark of BASF

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The ubiquitous presence of tiny fragments of synthetic or chemically modified natural polymers, which are insoluble in water, degrade very slowly and can easily be ingested by living organisms, raises concerns about their general impact on the environment and, potentially, on human health. Those tiny particles are widespread in the environment and have also been found in drinking water and food.

On September 25th, 2023, the European Commission published Commission Regulation (EU) 2023/2055 amending Annex XVII to Regulation (EC) No 1907/2006 (REACH) with Entry No. 78 regarding 'Synthetic Polymer Microparticles' – formerly known as 'intentionally added microplastics' – which entered into force on October 17th, 2023. Further information on the topic of microplastic can as well be found on the ECHA website.

The polymeric substance(s) contained in Laricyl® BC10206 are either of natural origin or demonstrate a solubility in water of > 2 g/l as proven in accordance with Appendix 16 to REACH Annex XVII, are degradable as proven in accordance with Appendix 15 to REACH Annex XVII, do not fulfill the definition of 'particle' in accordance with §2(a) given in the regulation or are 'liquid' in accordance with the conditions laid down in §2(d).

The Laricyl® BC10206 is therefore not subject to the restriction and rated based upon the best of our knowledge as

No SPM.

Please note that:

- While using a 'No SPM' rated product from BASF, there is a possibility of creating a cosmetic formulation that contains SPM, depending on the other components or reactants used during the customer's manufacturing process. It remains the responsibility of the customer to comply with the requirements of the SPM regulation for the cosmetic products they are placing on the market.
- The specifics of the potential information and reporting requirements are currently being defined and to be compiled in a Q&A document by the EU Commission. As a result, there are still unresolved questions regarding the practical implementation of the restriction. BASF closely monitors such activities and is involved in discussions via various industry associations to serve with most practical solutions for our product´s management.

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